

Tuğba Somuncu

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Position

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Teaching Assistant Professor, Department of Economics 2024–present

Education

Iowa State University

Ph.D., Economics 2018–2024

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid

M.S., Economic Analysis 2016–2018

Istanbul Technical University

M.S., Economics 2014–2016

Marmara University

B.Sc., Chemical Engineering 2008–2013

Erasmus Exchange Program, University of Bologna, Italy, Spring 2012

Research and Teaching Interests

Environmental Economics, Public & Health Economics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Principles of Economics

Working Papers

Fighting Fire with Fire(fighting Foam): The Long Run Effects of PFAS Use at U.S. Military Installations (with I. Jacqz and J. Voorheis) — [Press](#) and [U.S. Census Working Paper](#)

Disparities in PFAS Exposure (with I. Jacqz)

Environmental Regulations, Imperfect Mobility, and the Gender Adaptation Gap

Work in Progress

Extreme Weather, Hospital Closures, and Emergency Department Utilization in the United States (with A. Earle)

Teaching

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

ECON 455: Environmental Economic Theory (9 sections) F2024–present

ECON 410H: Intermediate Microeconomics (Honors) (3 sections) S2025–present

ECON 410: Intermediate Microeconomics (1 section) S2025

ECON 101: Introduction to Economics (2 sections) F2024–S2025

Iowa State University

ECON 321: Economics of Discrimination (1 section) S2022

Awards and Grants

Russell Sage Foundation (for Fighting Fire with Fire(fighting Foam))	2023
Teaching Excellence Award, Graduate College, Iowa State University	2022
Graduate Fellowship, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2016–2018
Best Scientific Presentation Award, ENERDAY	2016
Erasmus Exchange Grant	2012

Presentations

2023: Southern Economic Association 93rd Annual Meeting, AERE Annual Summer Conference

2022: Camp Resources XXVIII, Midwest Economics Association Annual Conference

2021: CSWEP Mentoring Workshop for Economics PhD Students

2020: Berkeley/Sloan Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics

2018: BC3 Basque Centre for Climate Change Summer School

2016: ENERDAY 11th Conference on Energy Economics and Technology

Student Advising

Anthony Roariker Swenson — Honors Thesis, Recipient of Highest Honors Distinction

Annabel Emmanuel Lissade — Honors Thesis

Brigit Pierce — Honors Thesis and Summer Research Advisor

Steven Yu — Summer Research Advisor; Recipient of Wesslen Research Award

Madison Kim — Honors Contract

All students at UNC Chapel Hill.

Service

Faculty Advisor for Graduate Students, Women in Economics, UNC Chapel Hill	2026
Member, Chair's Advisory Committee, UNC Chapel Hill	2025
Small Group Leader, ISU Cardinal Women Student Program	2022, 2023
Press Secretary, ISU Economics Graduate Student Association	2019

Referee

The Journal of Economic Inequality